

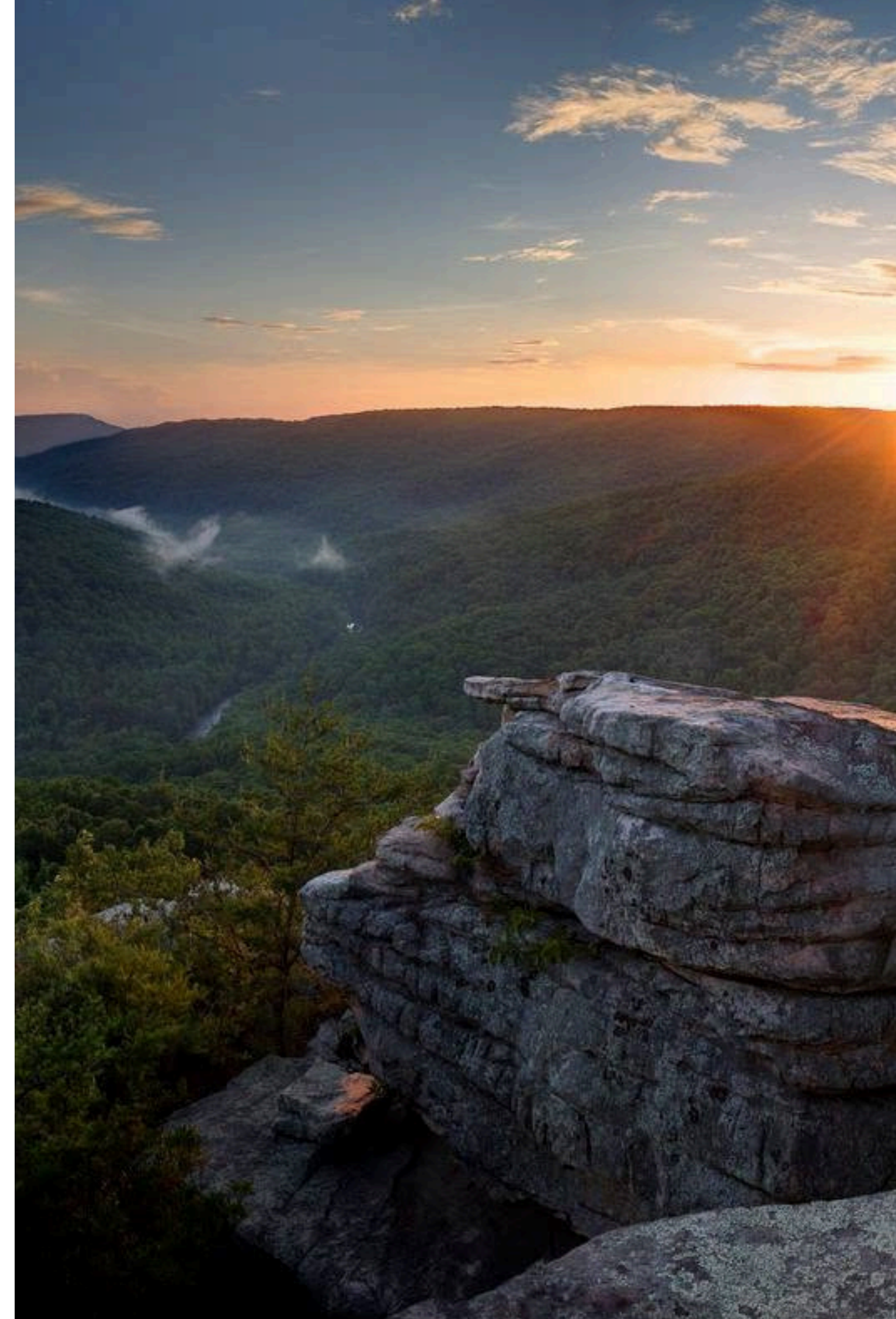


This is Bob.

(Cookeville, TN resident)

Value Proposition

No single employer, agency, or institution can move the workforce needle alone. The Upper Cumberland already has the relationships and the tools to act together. Collaboration is our differentiator.





Identified Cluster

Advanced Manufacturing

- It is one of the region's largest and most diverse sectors, spanning clay and ceramics, plastics, wood products, and automotive.
- Persistent turnover creates a clear, measurable problem we can solve together.
- Employers are ready for partnership, which makes a pilot realistic.

Strategic priority: Build Empower UC 2.0 as a cluster-based workforce participation system that helps residents enter, stay, and advance in jobs connected to resource-based advanced manufacturing and logistics.

- Collaboration is a documented regional strength. Our partners are already aligned and at the table.
- A proven toolkit already exists and can be customized for a cluster: career pathway app, healthcare bootcamp, executive functioning training.
- Modern tools and AI let us enhance and scale these resources cost-effectively.
- Advanced manufacturing's scale and turnover make it the highest-leverage place to prove the model. Success will be measured on employee retention.

90-Day Next Step

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Convene regional employers and partners.

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Reframe and expand Empower UC and communicate the new positioning.

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Define coordination structure.
UCDD/UCHRA, HEP, Chambers, etc.

90

Define impact metrics and milestones.

90

Articulate the renewed, broader vision.

12-Month Action Plan



Launch regional employer-led workforce council.



Pilot employer-connected workforce solutions.



Identify and secure ongoing funding sources.



Identify and address top workforce participation barriers.



Adapt Empower Upper Cumberland model for workforce navigation.



Develop shared regional dashboard for tracking progress.

Metrics for Success

1

Workforce Participation

Are more people entering and staying in the workforce.

2

Retention

Is employer turnover decreasing during the pilot period.

3

Wage Growth

Are participants moving into higher-paying roles.

4

Quality of Life

Are households reporting greater stability and prosperity.

Specifically tho -

THANK

You 4

The Counseling you
have provided for me.
I can not remember a time
when I had SO MUCH
fun once going on in

You're the best!

I my life as to where
I needed a Counselor - and one
was actually available - You
Guys are The Best - (as it says)
Christina is helping me so
much - and she's Amazing.
Lastly - I love the family
friendly type of workers we
have here - I am blessed to work
here - Thanks Bob Carr



Upper Cumberland Regional Action Plan: **Empower 2.0**

PDI Fellows, Zone 4: Stefanie Byrd, Samantha Cross, Adam Poe, Denny Wayne Robinson, Megan Spurgeon, Zach Stephens & Lisa Uhrik